

For Trump, the 250th party goes on and on

IndyCar race, athletic event for youths next on docket

By Jim Puzzanghera
and Julian E.J. Sorapuru

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Like the fleeting fireworks from coast to coast last week, America's 250th birthday has spectacularly come and gone. But that doesn't mean the party's over as far as the White House is concerned.

President Trump publicly laid out his plans in a video more than three years ago for a celebration that has clearly fascinated him. With a series of White House-orchestrated extravaganzas that reflect his personal taste still to come this summer, critics have lambasted the president's ideas for being too political and self-centered.

As the Great American State Fair (Trump's idea, although he originally envisioned it in Iowa) wrapped up on Friday on the National Mall, Washington is gearing up for two more major events in August: a competition for high school athletes called the Patriot Games and an IndyCar race in the shadow of the US Capitol building.

Even though Congress created a bipartisan commission known as America 250 in 2016 to plan the nation's celebration, Trump set up a rival White House-backed organization, Freedom 250, upon his return to the White House to make events, such as the UFC fights on the White House lawn in June, happen.

Democrats charge Trump has tried to make the celebration of a national milestone all about him.

"The America 250 Commission set out to bring our nation together by highlighting our shared history and values," Senator Jeanne Shaheen, a New Hampshire Democrat and one of eight members of Congress on the bipartisan panel, said in a statement to the Globe. "In complete contrast, President Trump's Freedom 250 has politicized what should be a moment for national unity, not personal glory or partisan point-scoring."

The White House hasn't provided details about

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Pain lingers from tragedy in Fall River

Answers elusive year after blaze at assisted living site tore apart community

By Jason Laughlin and Sean Cotter

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and Emily Spatz

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

FALL RIVER — A year after Massachusetts' deadliest fire in decades, the scorched bulk of Gabriel House remains a grim reminder of a tragedy that has scarred this city.

It's a symbol of the many unanswered questions that linger from the blaze that killed 10 and injured dozens at this assisted living home for seniors and people with disabilities.

State Attorney General Andrea Campbell's office is investigating the fire but remains silent on whether Dennis Etzkorn, Gabriel House's owner, will face criminal charges. The final report on the cause of the fire has yet to be publicly shared. Etzkorn faces a raft of lawsuits but had no liability insurance, prompting aggrieved families and former residents to plan a new suit that names other defendants.

The July 13, 2025, fire revealed the state's tolerance for poorly run assisted living residences, said state Senator Mark Montigny, who pushed for state regulators to prioritize new fire safety regulations after the blaze. The state has issued a suite of reforms aimed at preventing a similar tragedy, but officials acknowledge more should be done.

"This is just a first step in the process," he said

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Man fatally shot in Maine during an ICE operation



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Protesters demonstrated against ICE outside of Maine Senator Susan Collins's office in Biddeford.

Circumstances of shooting in Biddeford unclear; angry protests spread as a recent spate of violence mars immigrant crackdown

By Sabrina Shankman,
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GLOBE STAFF

BIDDEFORD, Maine — An ICE agent shot and killed a man Monday morning while attempting to serve a deportation order in this small coastal city, authorities said, sparking angry protests over the latest fatal encounter in the Trump administration's immigration crackdown.

The circumstances of the shooting remained unclear Monday night. The state attorney general's office said the victim allegedly "attempted to flee in a vehicle in the direction of the officer and was fatally shot." However, Senator Angus King's office said he was told by Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin that the victim was not the target of the immigration operation.

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JOSEPH PREZIOSO/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

FBI investigators worked the scene of the shooting.

Tossed about in Medford's municipal maelstrom



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

The bevy of complaints in Medford point to a uniquely divisive type of urban politics, with the mayor at the center of the storm.

Some fear City Hall becoming den of snooping, sniping, and uncivil action

By Danny McDonald

GLOBE STAFF

MEDFORD — In December 2024, an unused syringe was discovered inside a trash bin at a Department of Public Works garage. Having heard rumors that on-the-job drug use was commonplace, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn and other Medford officials decided to spring surprise drug tests on at least two dozen public works employees.

What happened next is the subject of federal litigation, part of a pattern that Lungo-Koehn says is pushback against her ef-

forts to modernize city government but which her critics allege is a hallmark of her tenure: acts they say are vindictive, morale crushing, and, at times, illegal.

A group of public works employees describe being forced, under threat of termination, to take urine drug tests and breathalyzers in a van in a parking lot of a DPW garage after the syringe was found, according to their federal lawsuit. The workers say the door of the van was left open during the tests, stripping them of their privacy as

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